



Research Funding Program

SCOPE-R

**Survey-based Collaborative Opportunities & Projects Enabling
Research**

Program Guidelines & Operating Information

Kirk Kerkorian School of Medicine at UNLV, Office of Research
Version 1.0, Effective Fiscal Year (2026-2027)

Document Control

Program title	SCOPE-R — Survey-based Collaborative Opportunities & Projects Enabling Research
Program type	Pilot program — offered on a quarterly basis for an initial one-year period; recurrence not guaranteed and subject to funding availability and program evaluation
Program owner	Office of Research, Kirk Kerkorian School of Medicine at UNLV
Applies to	Medical trainees (residents, fellows, students) and faculty within the Kirk Kerkorian School of Medicine
Application cycles	Quarterly (four cycles per year)
Version	1.0

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1. About the Program

SCOPE-R (Survey-based Collaborative Opportunities & Projects Enabling Research) is an internal program that supports medical trainees and faculty in designing and conducting survey-based research. Through the School's existing retained agreement with Qualtrics, the program provides selected applicants with access to the Qualtrics market-research data-collection services at no cost to the applicant, so they can collect high-quality data efficiently, advance scholarship, and strengthen the institution's research and educational mission. There is no cash award and applications are accepted on a quarterly cycle. SCOPE-R is offered as a pilot program. The quarterly cycles described in these guidelines cover the initial pilot period; continuation of the program beyond the pilot is not guaranteed and will depend on available funding and the results of program evaluation.

2. Background and Rationale

Survey research is a versatile, cost-effective method for studying clinical practice patterns, patient-reported outcomes, education, workforce well-being, and population health. Many trainees and faculty have strong research questions but lack the technical infrastructure and licensed data-collection services needed to field rigorous surveys and reach representative respondents. SCOPE-R addresses this gap by providing institutional access to the Qualtrics's market-research panel services under the School's retained agreement with Qualtrics, enabling investigators to recruit defined samples and collect data under appropriate ethical oversight, without any cost to the applicant.

3. Definitions

- **Survey-based research:** research in which the primary data are collected through structured questionnaires or instruments administered to human respondents.
- **Qualtrics:** the institution's licensed experience-management and survey platform used for instrument design, distribution, and data capture.
- **Qualtrics Market Research / online sample services:** services through which respondents matching defined criteria are recruited from managed panels to participate in a survey; for SCOPE-R these are provided under the school's retained agreement with Qualtrics at no cost to the applicant.
- **Trainee:** any medical trainee affiliated with the institution, including medical students, residents, and clinical or research fellows.
- **Faculty:** an individual holding a faculty appointment at the institution, at any rank.
- **Principal investigator (PI):** the individual who holds primary responsibility for the conduct, integrity, and reporting of a supported project.
- **IRB:** the Institutional Review Board responsible for the ethical review of human-subjects research.

4. Scope and Eligibility

4.1 Who may apply

Applications are open to medical trainees and faculty in good standing. Trainee applicants must identify a faculty mentor who agrees to oversee the project.

4.2 Application limit

Each individual may submit one application per fiscal year. A person who has already applied in a given fiscal year may be named on a second application only if that application involves a completely different project team and a distinct project. (This provision is under review; so, guidelines may be subject to change).

4.3 Eligible activities

The program supports survey-based research projects that use Qualtrics for instrument deployment and respondent [sample] recruitment. Projects must be feasible within the support period and consistent with the institution's research priorities.

4.4 What the program provides

SCOPE-R does not provide a cash award. Selected applicants receive access to the Qualtrics Market Research panel/online-sample services, drawn from the School's retained agreement with Qualtrics at no cost to the applicant. Applicants in any of the categories below are eligible; the number of projects supported per cycle is set by the Office of Research and published in each call for applications, based on the capacity of the agreement.

Applicant category	Eligible applicants	What SCOPE-R provides
Trainee	Residents, fellows, students (with faculty mentor)	Access to the Qualtrics's Market Research panel/sample under the retained agreement at no cost to the applicant
Faculty	Faculty (any rank)	Same as above
Collaborative	Trainee + faculty team	Same as above

5. Application Cycles and Deadlines

Applications are accepted on a quarterly basis during the pilot period, as shown below. Continuation of cycles beyond the pilot is subject to available funding and program review. Applications must be submitted by the deadline for the cycle; late submissions are held for the next available cycle.

Cycle	Cycle dates	Application deadline
Q1	July 1 – September 30, 2026	September 10, 2026
Q2	October 1 – December 31, 2026	December 10, 2026
Q3	January 1 – March 31, 2027	March 10, 2027
Q4	April 1 – June 30, 2027	June 10, 2027

6. Application Materials

A complete application consists of the cover information entered in this form plus the uploads listed below. Incomplete applications are not reviewed.

- **Application cover information:** applicant name, role (trainee or faculty), department/division, and contact information (UNLV email and phone); Principal Investigator (PI) name and email; and the project title — all entered directly in the online application form.
- **Application packet (single PDF):** one combined PDF, assembled in the following order: (a) a structured abstract (approximately 150 words); (b) a research plan (approximately 250 words: background and significance, specific aims, and expected impact); (c) the target population, with explicit inclusion and exclusion criteria, their rationale, and the planned sample size; (d) the survey methodology (instrument, sampling and recruitment plan, and how the instrument is designed to support future research questions and downstream reuse of the data); (e) a dissemination plan with specific products, intended venues, and a timeline; (f) a project timeline of key milestones from award to completion and reporting; (g) team members and their roles, with short bio sketches for the PI and key members; (h) the IRB approval/outcome letter together with the approved, detailed IRB protocol; (i) a letter of support from the PI or faculty mentor, on departmental letterhead; and (j) for faculty-initiated projects, a letter of support from the department chair, on departmental letterhead.

7. How to Apply

Assemble the materials listed in Section 6, then submit them through the program's online application form, which is hosted in Qualtrics:

[Application link:](https://unlv.co1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_eS8oofQ2dbrZCCO)
https://unlv.co1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_eS8oofQ2dbrZCCO

The Qualtrics form captures applicant details, the structured abstract, and the target population (inclusion and exclusion criteria), and allows upload of supporting documents (research plan, CV/bio sketch, mentor/PI support letter). Applicants receive an automatic confirmation on submission. Applications must be submitted by the deadline for the cycle (Section 5); late submissions are held for the next cycle. There is no budget to prepare and no cost to the applicant; applicants are encouraged to contact the program team early with questions about scope or use of Qualtrics services.

8. Review and Selection

A review committee convened by the Office of Research scores each application against the standardized rubric below. Beyond scientific merit, the rubric deliberately rewards three things: a clearly defined target population with sound inclusion and exclusion criteria, a concrete dissemination plan with specific products and timelines, and a survey design built so the resulting dataset can support multiple future research questions for the Kirk Kerkorian School of Medicine and its trainees. Committee members recuse themselves from any application presenting a conflict of interest. Selection is based on the rubric score, alignment with program goals, and the available capacity of the Qualtrics agreement, and is communicated in writing after each cycle.

Criterion	Weight	What you need to address
Significance and relevance of the research question	20%	State a clear, important research question; explain the gap it fills and why it matters to clinical practice, education, workforce well-being, or

		population health. Tie it to the School of Medicine and institutional research priorities.
Methodological rigor and survey design quality	20%	Describe a well-constructed instrument (validated items where possible), a sound sampling and recruitment plan, a justified sample size, and how bias and data quality are handled.
Clearly defined target population with sound inclusion and exclusion criteria	10%	Define the intended respondents precisely, list explicit inclusion and exclusion criteria with their rationale, and specify the planned sample size and screening criteria for any Qualtrics panel.
Survey design that opens future research questions (designed so the dataset can support multiple downstream studies for the School of Medicine and its trainees)	15%	Show the instrument is built to answer more than the immediate question, so the resulting dataset can support multiple downstream studies for the School of Medicine and its trainees. Note reusable variables and secondary-analysis potential.
Feasibility, timeline, and appropriate use of Qualtrics services	15%	Provide a realistic timeline with milestones that fits the support period, confirm the project is achievable, and specify how Qualtrics will be used, including any Market Research panel (target size, screening criteria, estimated incidence).
Concrete dissemination plan (specific targets: abstracts, presentations, manuscripts, with venues and timeline)	10%	Name specific products (abstracts, presentations, manuscripts), the intended venues, and a timeline — not vague intentions.
Applicant / team qualifications and mentorship plan	10%	Include biosketches or CVs for the PI and key personnel showing relevant expertise, define each member's role, and (for trainees) name a faculty mentor with a signed letter of support confirming oversight and feasibility.

9. Ethical and Regulatory Requirements

Because SCOPE-R supports research involving human respondents, compliance with the following is mandatory and is a condition of any award.

- **IRB review:** Investigators must hold IRB approval or a documented exemption determination at the time of application, and must upload the approved, detailed protocol and the IRB approval/outcome letter with the application. Data collection (including any Qualtrics panel deployment) may not begin until this is in place.
- **Informed consent:** Respondents must be provided appropriate consent or information consistent with the approved protocol.
- **Privacy and data protection:** Investigators must safeguard respondent data, minimize collection of identifiers, and comply with applicable privacy laws and institutional data-governance and information-security policies.
- **Responsible conduct of research:** All personnel must complete required research-ethics and human-subjects training prior to beginning the project.

- **Vendor and panel compliance:** Use of Qualtrics Market Research panel services must be disclosed to and approved by the IRB, and must conform to the platform's terms of use and the institution's data-handling agreements.

10. Use of Qualtrics Services

The Office of Research coordinates institutional Qualtrics access for awardees under the school's retained agreement with Qualtrics. Investigators are responsible for building, testing, and accessibility-checking their instruments. Where Qualtrics Market Research panel/online sample is needed, the applicant specifies the target sample size and the screening criteria (the inclusion and exclusion criteria for the target population); the Office of Research arranges the panel deployment within the terms and capacity of the agreement. There is no charge to the applicant and no quote or purchase is required. Data collected through the platform remain subject to institutional ownership and data-governance policies.

11. Data Stewardship and Downstream Use

Data collected under a SCOPE-R award reside with the Office of Research, which serves as the steward of the dataset. This stewardship model is intended to preserve the value of each survey for the broader Kirk Kerkorian School of Medicine community, consistent with the approved IRB protocol and applicable privacy requirements.

- **Data residence:** The complete dataset, instrument, codebook, and documentation are deposited with the Office of Research at the close of the project. Awardees retain access to their data for their study.
- **Design for reuse:** Applicants are expected to design instruments that can answer more than the immediate research question, so the resulting data can support additional studies by faculty and trainees over time. This forward-looking design is a scored element of the review rubric (Section 8).
- **Downstream access:** De-identified data may be made available by the Office of Research for secondary analysis by Kirk Kerkorian School of Medicine faculty and trainees, subject to IRB approval for the new use, an appropriate data-use agreement, and any consent limitations in the original protocol. The original investigators are acknowledged in downstream work.
- **Privacy safeguards:** All downstream use must protect respondent privacy, honor the terms of the original informed consent, and comply with institutional data-governance and information-security policies.

12. Award Terms and Conditions

- Qualtrics access and any Market Research panel deployment are provided under, and subject to, the institution's retained agreement with Qualtrics and its terms of use.
- The support period is typically twelve months; extensions may be requested in writing before expiration.
- Access is limited to the approved project; any change in PI, scope, target population, or methodology requires notification and may require re-review.

- Failure to meet reporting or compliance obligations may result in suspension of access and ineligibility for future cycles.

13. Reporting and Deliverables

Each awardee submits a final report within sixty days of the end of the support period describing the project's aims, methods, target population and sample, key findings, and dissemination outcomes. Awardees are expected to present results internally and to pursue external dissemination (abstract, poster, or manuscript) where appropriate. Reports inform the program's annual evaluation.

14. Authorship, Acknowledgment, and Dissemination

Authorship follows recognized standards for scholarly contribution. All publications, presentations, and other products arising from a supported project must acknowledge SCOPE-R support. Awardees are encouraged to share de-identified findings to maximize educational and scientific impact.

15. Program Administration and Review

The Office of Research administers the program: issuing the call for each cycle, convening the review committee, coordinating Qualtrics access under the retained agreement, and reporting on outcomes. The program is reviewed at least annually, and metrics such as number of applications, projects supported, projects reaching IRB approval, completion rate, and scholarly outputs are tracked to assess impact and inform improvements.

16. Frequently Asked Questions

- **Who can apply?**
Any medical trainee in good standing, including medical students, residents, and clinical or research fellows and any faculty member. Trainees must have a faculty mentor.
- **How often can I apply?**
Each person may submit one application per fiscal year. A person who has already applied may be named on a second application only if it involves a completely different project team and a distinct project (this provision is under review).
- **Is SCOPE-R a permanent program?**
SCOPE-R is currently offered as a pilot. The quarterly cycles run for an initial pilot period; whether the program continues afterward depends on available funding and the results of program evaluation.
- **When are applications due?**
Applications are reviewed quarterly. See Section 5 for the cycle dates and deadlines; deadlines fall on the 10th of the final month of each quarter.
- **How do I submit my application?**
Through the program's Qualtrics application form (link in Section 7). The form accepts your responses and uploaded documents, and sends an automatic confirmation.

- **Do I need IRB approval before I apply?**

Yes. IRB approval (or a formal exemption determination) is required at the time of application. You must upload your approved, detailed IRB protocol and the IRB approval/outcome letter with your application. Data collection may begin only once approval is in place.

- **What does SCOPE-R provide?**

Access to the Qualtrics's Market Research panel/online sample, under the School's retained agreement with Qualtrics. SCOPE-R does not provide a cash award, and there is no cost to you.

- **Is there any cost to me, or a budget to prepare?**

No. There is no application budget and no cost to applicants. The Qualtrics platform and panel/sample services are covered by the School's retained agreement with Qualtrics.

- **Do I have to use Qualtrics?**

Yes for instrument deployment. Qualtrics Market Research panel services are used when you need to recruit a defined external sample; you simply specify the target sample size and inclusion/exclusion criteria, and the Office of Research arranges deployment under the institutional agreement, no quote or payment is required.

- **How are applications reviewed?**

A review committee scores applications against weighted criteria (Section 8). Decisions are communicated in writing after each cycle.

- **What is the support period?**

The support period is typically twelve months; extensions may be requested in writing before expiration.

- **Who owns the data, and can it be reused later?**

Data collected under an award reside with the Office of Research as steward. De-identified data may be reused for future studies by Kirk Kerkorian School of Medicine faculty and trainees, subject to IRB approval for the new use, a data-use agreement, and the original consent terms. You are expected to design your survey so the dataset can support multiple research questions over time (see Section 11).

- **How should I acknowledge the award?**

All publications, presentations, and other products must acknowledge SCOPE-R support provided by the Office of Research.

- **Who do I contact with questions?**

The Office of Research at research@medicine.unlv.edu

17. Additional Contact Information

Questions about the program, eligibility, or applications should be directed to the Office of Research:

Dr. Kavita Batra — kavita.batra@unlv.edu; Aakansha Singh- aakansha.singh@unlv.edu